

How-to create your own skirmish AI

This guide covers how you can create your own AI for skirmish. Creating a scenario/campaign AI will be covered in another section.

Creating your own AI (personality)

In order to be able to add an AI to the game you must create a local mod, this is the only way to get your files to be picked up.

1. Navigate to: “`..\Users\<your username>\Games\Age of Mythology Retold\<steam ID numbers>\mods\local`”.
2. Create a folder with the name you chose for your mod, enter the new folder. In the next steps we must re-create the file structure the main game also has so that our custom files are in the right place.
3. Create a folder with the name “`game`”, enter the new folder.
4. Create a folder with the name “`ai`”, enter the new folder.
5. Create a folder with the name “`personalities`”, enter the new folder.
6. Create a file with the name “`personalities_mods.xml`”, make sure the file extension is properly set to .xml and not .txt.
7. Open the new xml file. Example of contents:

```
1 <?xml version="1.0" encoding="UTF-8"?>
2
3 <personalitiesmods>
4     <Personality>Test</Personality>
5 </personalitiesmods>
```

The name you give the personality here between `<>` is also the name it can be identified with in the script, for example this would generate `cPersonalityTest`.

8. Still inside the personalities folder create a file with the name “`Test.personality`”, make sure the file extension is properly set to .personality and not .txt.
9. Open the new personality file. Example of contents:

```
1 <?xml version="1.0" encoding="UTF-8"?>
2
3 <AI>
4     <script>chairon</script>
5     <nameID>STR_MP_AI_ATK</nameID>
6     <tooltipID>STR_MP_AI_ATK</tooltipID>
7     <chatset>Shared</chatset>
8     <playerNames>
9         <nameID culture="Greek">STR_CITY_GREEK_ATHENS</nameID>
10
11         <nameID culture="Egyptian">STR_CITY_EGYPTIAN_MEMPHIS</nameID>
12
13         <nameID culture="Norse">STR_CITY_NORSE_NIDAROS</nameID>
14
15         <nameID culture="Atlantean">STR_CITY_ATLANTEAN_KASTOR</nameID>
16     </playerNames>
17 </AI>
```

What we’ve done now is create a carbon copy of the attacker personality as it is by default in the game. You can however adjust anything in here to actually create a custom AI:

script: This is the name of the XS file that will be loaded when this AI is selected, it's your start point. From here you can create any include chain that you would like with your own files. See `chairon.xs` for an example of how the official AI does it.

nameID: This text shows in the skirmish lobby AI dropdown. Must be a string from the stringtable.

tooltipID: This text shows when you hover over the AI inside the skirmish lobby setup. Must be a string from the stringtable.

chatset: The AI is able to send chat messages during the game. What messages are available is defined in "`root\game\ai\chatsets.xml`". There is no additive modding available for this file. If you want your own chats you must copy this file to your mod and adjust it.

playerNames: These are the names your AI can randomly get while in-game, the default AI uses city names for this. the "`culture`" tag identifies which culture the name can be used for. The nameID must be a string from the stringtable.

Overwriting parts of the main AI without creating a custom AI

To achieve this we again need a local mod as described above, but we don't perform the steps related to personalities. Instead you can now place files in this mod's ai folder with the same name as the main AI uses. You can overwrite specific files in this way. **Attention:** if you mod the main AI in this manner you must be wary each official patch. Since the script files you've modified will likely be changed and your mod won't have those changes. Knowing how to keep track of official changes and then knowing how to merge these with your changes each patch is required.